

English Grammar: Sentence Basics

A complete English sentence normally has a subject and a predicate. The subject identifies who or what the sentence is about. The predicate contains a verb and says something about the subject.

A noun names a person, place, thing, or idea. A pronoun can replace a noun. A verb expresses an action or state. An adjective describes a noun, while an adverb often modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb.

In the simple present, add s or es to most verbs after he, she, or it: 'She studies.' Use the base form with I, you, we, and they: 'They study.'

A paragraph develops one main idea. A clear topic sentence introduces that idea, supporting sentences explain it with reasons or examples, and a concluding sentence closes the thought.